Promotion/Relegation

Edit This

In my imaginary new system, MLB would combine the National League and American League into one Baseball Premier League (BPL) comprising the current 30 major league teams.

The top eight BPL teams would have a playoff consisting of three rounds of seven-game series. Seedings would be based on overall record (using run differential as a tie-breaker, if needed). 1 vs 8, 2 vs 7, etc., — higher seed hosting — culminating in a World Series. This would be the same number of rounds in the current MLB playoffs.

The Triple-A Pacific Coast League and International League would combine to form a Baseball League 2 (BL2). No longer would this tier be affiliated with major league (BPL) clubs.

The bottom three BPL teams would be relegated to the BL2. The top two BL2 teams would automatically get promoted to the BPL.

The next four teams in the BL2 standings would play a two-round series of seven games each, seeded by overall record, home field advantage going to the team with the better record. Winner of this BL2 promotion playoff would move up to the BPL.

The Double-A Southern, Eastern, and Texas Leagues would combine to form a Baseball League 3 (BL3). As with BL2, clubs from this level would not be affiliated with the BPL.

The bottom three BL2 teams would be relegated to the BL3. The top two BL3 teams would automatically get promoted to the BL2.

As with the BL2, the next four teams in the BL3 standings would play a two-round series of seven games each, seeded by overall record, home field advantage going to the team with the better record. Winner of this BL3 promotion playoff would move up to the BL2.

The Single-A structure could still be used by the upper three leagues as a farm system.

As Sam says, the prospect of relegation keeps fans of poor performing teams interested (albeit not happily!) while allowing for a "natural order" of the better teams rising to the higher leagues (and more money) and worse teams being demoted due to lack of performance.

Lots of current baseball tradition would have to be sacrificed, and stadium rules and scheduling would be a challenge, but the competition could be as intriguing as the Barclays English Premier League!

2013 Baseball Standings

BPL	Team	W	L	RD
AL-E	***Boston	97	65	197
NL-C	**St. Louis	97	65	187
AL-W	*Oakland	96	66	142
NL-E	*Atlanta	96	66	140
NL-C	*Pittsburgh	94	68	57
AL-C	*Detroit	93	69	172
AL-C	*Cleveland	92	70	83
NL-W	*Los Angeles	92	70	67
AL-E	*Tampa Bay	92	71	54
AL-W	Texas	91	72	94
NL-C	*Cincinnati	90	72	109
AL-C	Kansas City	86	76	47
NL-E	Washington	86	76	30
AL-	Baltimore	85	77	36

BL2	Team	W	L
INTL	Durham	87	57
PCL	Oklahoma City	82	62
PCL	Las Vegas	81	63
INTL	Paw tucket	80	63
INTL	Indianapolis	80	64
PCL	Sacramento	79	65
PCL	Salt Lake	78	66
INTL	Rochester	77	67
INTL	Norfolk	77	67
PCL	Tucson	77	67
PCL	Albuquerque	76	68
PCL	Tacoma	76	68
INTL	Buffalo	74	70
PCL	Round Rock	73	71
INTL	Lehigh Valley	72	72
PCL	New Orleans	72	72
INTL	Columbus	71	73
PCL	Omaha	70	74
INTL	Louisville	69	75
PCL	Memphis	69	75
PCL	Fresno	68	75

BL3	Team	W	L
EAST	Binghamton	86	55
TEX	Corpus Christi	83	57
SOU	Mobile	79	60
TEX	San Antonio	78	61
SOU	Birmingham	77	63
EAST	Harrisburg	77	65
SOU	Tennessee	76	62
SOU	Mississippi	76	63
EAST	Erie	76	66
EAST	Trenton	74	67
SOU	Jacksonville	73	63
TEX	Arkansas	73	66
SOU	Montgomery	71	69
EAST	Bow ie	71	71
TEX	Frisco	70	70
EAST	Richmond	70	72
TEX	Tulsa	68	70
EAST	New Hampshire	68	72
EAST	Portland	68	73
EAST	Akron	68	73
EAST	New Britain	66	76

Search

- **2013**
  PROMOTION/RELEGATION

AL-E	***Boston	97	65	197
NL-C	**St. Louis	97	65	187
AL-W	*Oakland	96	66	142
NL-E	*Atlanta	96	66	140
NL-C	*Pittsburgh	94	68	57
AL-C	*Detroit	93	69	172
AL-C	*Cleveland	92	70	83
NL-W	*Los Angeles	92	70	67
AL-C	Chicago	63	99	-125
NL-E	Miami	62	100	-133
AL-W	Houston	51	111	-238

*** = 2013 World Series winner
** = 2013 World Series loser
* = in 2013 MLB playoffs

2013 BPL first-round matchups:

- • (1) Boston Red Sox vs (8) Los Angeles Dodgers
- • (4) Atlanta Braves vs (5) Pittsburgh Pirates
- • (3) Oakland Athletics vs (6) Detroit Tigers
- • (2) St. Louis Cardinals vs (7) Cleveland Indians

BL2	Team	W	L
INTL	Durham	87	57
PCL	Oklahoma City	82	62
PCL	Las Vegas	81	63
INTL	Pawtucket	80	63
INTL	Indianapolis	80	64
PCL	Sacramento	79	65
INTL	Gwinnett	60	84
PCL	Reno	60	84
PCL	Nashville	57	87

BL3	Team	W	L
EAST	Binghamton	86	55
TEX	Corpus Christi	83	57
SOU	Mobile	79	60
TEX	San Antonio	78	61
SOU	Birmingham	77	63
EAST	Harrisburg	77	65

E	Baltimore	85	77	36
AL-E	New York	85	77	-21
NL-W	Arizona	81	81	-10
AL-W	Los Angeles	78	84	-4
NL-W	San Francisco	76	86	-62
NL-W	San Diego	76	86	-82
AL-E	Toronto	74	88	-44
NL-C	Milwaukee	74	88	-47
NL-W	Colorado	74	88	-54
NL-E	New York	74	88	-65
NL-E	Philadelphia	73	89	-139
AL-W	Seattle	71	91	-130
NL-C	Chicago	66	96	-87
AL-C	Minnesota	66	96	-174
AL-C	Chicago	63	99	-125
NL-E	Miami	62	100	-133
AL-W	Houston	51	111	-238

*** = 2013 World Series winner
** = 2013 World Series loser
* = in 2013 MLB playoffs

INTL	Scranton/Wilkes-Barre	68	76
PCL	Colorado Springs	67	76
INTL	Syracuse	66	78
PCL	Iowa	66	78
INTL	Charlotte	65	78
INTL	Toledo	61	83
INTL	Gwinnett	60	84
PCL	Reno	60	84
PCL	Nashville	57	87

TEX	Springfield	64	74
EAST	Altoona	63	79
SOU	Jackson	62	73
TEX	Midland	62	78
EAST	Reading	62	80
SOU	Huntsville	59	79
SOU	Pensacola	59	79
SOU	Chattanooga	59	80
TEX	Northwest Arkansas	59	81

The 2013 BPL first-round matchups:

- (1) Boston Red Sox vs (8) Los Angeles Dodgers
- (4) Atlanta Braves vs (5) Pittsburgh Pirates
- (3) Oakland Athletics vs (6) Detroit Tigers
- (2) St. Louis Cardinals vs (7) Cleveland Indians

2012 Baseball Standings

BPL	Team	W	L	RD
NL-E	*Washington	98	64	137
NL-C	*Cincinnati	97	65	81
AL-E	*New York	95	67	136
NL-E	*Atlanta	94	68	100
AL-W	*Oakland	94	68	99
NL-W	***San Francisco	94	68	69
AL-W	*Texas	93	69	101
AL-E	*Baltimore	93	69	7
AL-E	Tampa Bay	90	72	120
AL-W	Los Angeles	89	73	68
NL-C	*St Louis	88	74	117
AL-C	**Detroit	88	74	56
NL-W	Los Angeles	86	76	40
AL-C	Chicago	85	88	72

BL2	Team	W	L
INTL	Indianapolis	89	55
PCL	Sacramento	86	58
INTL	Scranton/WB	84	60
INTL	Charlotte	83	61
PCL	Omaha	83	61
PCL	Reno	81	63
PCL	Albuquerque	80	64
PCL	Las Vegas	79	64
INTL	Pawtucket	79	65
PCL	Oklahoma City	78	65
INTL	Lehigh Valley	75	68
PCL	Colorado Springs	75	69
INTL	Columbus	75	69
PCL	Fresno	74	70
INTL	Norfolk	74	70
PCL	New Orleans	73	67
PCL	Salt Lake	73	71
INTL	Rochester	72	72
INTL	Syracuse	70	74
PCL	Round Rock	69	75
INTL	Buffalo	67	76
PCL	Nashville	67	77
INTL	Durham	66	78

BL3	Team	W	L
EAST	Akron	82	59
TEX	Corpus Christi	81	59
TEX	Frisco	80	60
SOU	Jackson	79	61
EAST	Trenton	79	63
EAST	Bowie	78	64
TEX	Springfield	77	61
EAST	Reading	76	66
TEX	Tulsa	75	64
EAST	New Britain	75	67
SOU	Montgomery	74	63
SOU	Chattanooga	73	65
SOU	Tennessee	72	68
EAST	Altoona	72	70
SOU	Jacksonville	70	70
EAST	Richmond	70	71
SOU	Mobile	69	71
SOU	Pensacola	68	70
EAST	Portland	68	73
EAST	Binghamton	68	74
SOU	Huntsville	65	74
TEX	Midland	64	74
EAST	Harrisburg	64	78

NL-C	Milw aukee	83	79	43
NL-W	Arizona	81	81	46
NL-E	Philadelphia	81	81	4
NL-C	Pittsburgh	79	83	-23
NL-W	San Diego	76	86	-59
AL-W	Seattle	75	87	-32
NL-E	New York	74	88	-59
AL-E	Toronto	73	89	-68
AL-C	Kansas City	72	90	-70
AL-E	Boston	69	93	-72
NL-E	Miami	69	93	-115
AL-C	Cleveland	68	94	-178
AL-C	Minnesota	66	96	-131
NL-W	Colorado	64	98	-132
NL-C	Chicago	61	101	-146
NL-C	Houston	55	107	-211

*** = 2012 World Series w inner
** = 2012 World Series loser
* = in 2012 MLB playoffs

INTL	Durham	66	78
PCL	Tacoma	63	81
INTL	Gw innett	62	82
INTL	Toledo	60	84
PCL	Memphis	57	87
PCL	Tucson	56	88
PCL	Iow a	53	87
INTL	Louisville	51	93

EAST	Harrisburg	64	78
SOU	Birmingham	63	76
SOU	Mississippi	62	77
TEX	Arkansas	62	78
EAST	New Hampshire	61	81
TEX	San Antonio	60	80
TEX	NW Arkansas	58	81
EAST	Erie	57	84

The 2012 BPL first-round matchups:

- (1) Washington Senators vs (8) Baltimore Orioles
- (4) Atlanta Braves vs (5) Oakland Athletics
- (3) New York Yankees vs (6) San Francisco Giants
- (2) Cincinnati Reds vs (7) Texas Rangers

2011 Baseball Standings

BPL	Team	W	L	RD
NL-E	*Philadelphia	102	60	184
AL-E	*New York	97	65	210
NL-C	*Milw aukee	96	66	83
AL-W	**Texas	96	66	178
AL-C	*Detroit	95	67	76
NL-W	*Arizona	94	68	69
AL-E	*Tampa Bay	91	71	93
AL-E	Boston	90	72	138
NL-C	***St Louis	90	72	70
NL-E	Atlanta	89	73	36
AL-W	Los Angeles	86	76	34
NL-W	San Francisco	86	76	-8
NL-	Los			

BL2	Team	W	L
INTL	Columbus	88	56
PCL	Sacramento	88	56
PCL	Round Rock	87	57
INTL	Paw tucket	81	61
INTL	Durham	80	62
INTL	Lehigh Valley	80	64
PCL	Omaha	79	63
INTL	Gw innett	78	65
PCL	Memphis	77	66
PCL	Reno	77	67
INTL	Indianapolis	76	68
INTL	Scranton/WB	73	69
INTL	Louisville	73	71
PCL	Las Vegas	71	73
PCL	Nashville	71	73
PCL	Albuquerque	70	74
PCL	Tacoma	70	74
INTL	Charlotte	69	74
PCL	New Orleans	69	74
PCL	Oklahoma City	68	75
INTL	Toledo	67	77

BL3	Team	W	L
TEX	San Antonio	94	46
SOU	Mobile	84	54
SOU	Tennessee	83	57
EAST	Harrisburg	80	62
TEX	Frisco	79	61
SOU	Chattanooga	77	62
EAST	New Hampshire	77	65
EAST	Richmond	76	66
EAST	Bow ie	75	66
EAST	Reading	74	68
TEX	NW Arkansas	73	64
EAST	Akron	73	69
EAST	New Britain	72	70
SOU	Birmingham	71	69
SOU	Jacksonville	70	70
TEX	Arkansas	68	69
SOU	Jackson	68	72
TEX	Tulsa	68	72
EAST	Trenton	68	73
EAST	Erie	67	75
SOU	Montgomery	65	74

W	Angeles	82	79	32
AL-E	Toronto	81	81	-18
NL-E	Washington	80	81	-19
AL-C	Cleveland	80	82	-56
AL-C	Chicago	79	83	-52
NL-C	Cincinnati	79	83	15
NL-E	New York	77	85	-24
AL-W	Oakland	74	88	-34
NL-W	Colorado	73	89	-39
NL-E	Florida	72	90	-77
NL-C	Pittsburgh	72	90	-102
NL-C	Chicago	71	91	-102
AL-C	Kansas City	71	91	-32
NL-W	San Diego	71	91	-18
AL-E	Baltimore	69	93	-152
AL-W	Seattle	67	95	-119
AL-C	Minnesota	63	99	-185
NL-C	Houston	56	106	-181

INTL	Syracuse	66	74
PCL	Iowa	66	77
PCL	Fresno	65	79
PCL	Tuscon	65	79
PCL	Colorado Springs	64	80
PCL	Salt Lake	62	82
INTL	Buffalo	61	82
INTL	Norfolk	56	87
INTL	Rochester	53	91

EAST	Binghamton	65	76
SOU	Huntsville	64	73
EAST	Altoona	64	77
TEX	Midland	63	77
TEX	Springfield	62	78
SOU	Mississippi	61	79
EAST	Portland	59	83
SOU	Carolina	53	86
TEX	Corpus Christi	50	90

*** = 2011 World Series winner
** = 2011 World Series loser
* = in 2011 MLB playoffs

The 2011 BPL first-round matchups:

- (1) Philadelphia Phillies vs (8) Boston Red Sox
- (4) Texas Rangers vs (5) Detroit Tigers
- (3) Milwaukee Brewers vs (6) Arizona Diamondbacks
- (2) New York Yankees vs (7) Tampa Bay Rays

2010 Baseball Standings

BPL	Team	W	L
NL-E	*Philadelphia	97	65
AL-E	*Tampa Bay	96	66
AL-E	*New York	95	67
AL-C	*Minnesota	94	68
NL-W	***San Francisco	92	70
NL-E	*Atlanta	91	71
NL-C	*Cincinnati	91	71
AL-W	**Texas	90	72
NL-W	San Diego	90	72
AL-E	Boston	89	73
AL-C	Chicago	88	74
NL-C	St Louis	86	76
AL-E	Toronto	85	77
NL-W	Colorado	83	79
AL-C	Detroit	81	81
AL-W	Oakland	81	81
NL-E	Florida	80	82
AL-W	Los Angeles	80	82
NL-W	Los Angeles	80	82

BL2	Team	W	L
INTL	Durham	88	55
INTL	Scranton/WB	87	56
PCL	Iowa	82	62
PCL	Memphis	82	62
PCL	Omaha	81	63
INTL	Louisville	79	64
INTL	Columbus	79	65
PCL	Sacramento	79	65
PCL	Nashville	77	67
INTL	Syracuse	76	67
INTL	Buffalo	76	68
PCL	Fresno	75	69
PCL	Tacoma	74	69
PCL	Okla City	73	70
PCL	Salt Lake	73	71
PCL	Albuquerque	72	71
INTL	Gwinnett	72	71
INTL	Indianapolis	71	73
INTL	Toledo	70	73

BL3	Team	W	L
SOU	Tennessee	86	53
TEX	NW Arkansas	86	54
EAST	Trenton	83	59
EAST	Altoona	82	60
SOU	Jacksonville	81	59
EAST	New Hampshire	79	62
EAST	Harrisburg	77	65
TEX	Springfield	76	64
SOU	Mobile	75	62
EAST	Bowie	75	67
SOU	West Tenn	73	66
SOU	Montgomery	72	66
TEX	Frisco	72	67
EAST	Akron	71	71
TEX	Midland	70	70
EAST	Portland	70	71
TEX	Tulsa	69	70
EAST	Reading	69	72
TEX	San Antonio	68	72

NL-W	Los Angeles	80	82	INTL	Toledo	70	73	TEX	San Antonio	68	72
NL-E	New York	79	83	PCL	Reno	69	74	EAST	Richmond	68	73
NL-C	Milwaukee	77	85	INTL	Charlotte	67	77	SOU	Huntsville	67	73
NL-C	Houston	76	86	INTL	Norfolk	67	77	EAST	Binghamton	66	76
NL-C	Chicago	75	87	PCL	New Orleans	66	77	EAST	Erie	66	76
AL-C	Cleveland	69	93	PCL	Las Vegas	66	78	SOU	Chattanooga	65	74
NL-E	Washington	69	93	INTL	Pawtucket	66	78	SOU	Mississippi	63	74
AL-C	Kansas City	67	95	PCL	Colorado Springs	64	79	TEX	Corpus Christi	63	77
AL-E	Baltimore	66	96	PCL	Portland	59	85	SOU	Carolina	58	79
NL-W	Arizona	65	97	INTL	Lehigh Valley	58	86	TEX	Arkansas	55	85
AL-W	Seattle	61	101	PCL	Round Rock	57	87	SOU	Birmingham	53	87
NL-C	Pittsburgh	57	105	INTL	Rochester	49	95	EAST	New Britain	44	98

*** = 2010 World Series winner
** = 2010 World Series loser
* = in 2010 MLB playoffs

The 2010 BPL first-round matchups:

- (1) Philadelphia Phillies vs (8) Texas Rangers
- (4) Minnesota Twins vs (5) San Francisco Giants
- (3) New York Yankees vs (6) Atlanta Braves
- (2) Tampa Bay Rays vs (7) Cincinnati Reds

2009 Baseball Standings

BPL	Team	W	L	BL2	Team	W	L	BL3	Team	W	L
AL-E	***New York	103	59	PCL	Sacramento	86	57	SOU	Birmingham	92	47
AL-W	*Los Angeles	97	65	INTL	Louisville	84	58	EAST	Akron	89	53
NL-W	*Los Angeles	95	67	INTL	Durham	83	61	EAST	Connecticut	83	59
AL-E	Boston	95	67	INTL	Scranton/WB	81	60	SOU	Jacksonville	82	58
NL-E	**Philadelphia	93	69	INTL	Gwinnett	81	63	TEX	Midland	78	62
NL-W	Colorado	92	70	PCL	Albuquerque	80	64	EAST	Reading	75	67
NL-C	*St. Louis	91	71	PCL	Reno	79	64	TEX	Tulsa	74	66
NL-W	San Francisco	88	74	PCL	Memphis	77	67	TEX	NW Arkansas	73	67
NL-E	Florida	87	75	INTL	Syracuse	76	68	EAST	Bowie	73	69
AL-W	Texas	87	75	PCL	Nashville	75	69	TEX	Frisco	72	68
AL-C	*Minnesota	87	76	PCL	Tacoma	74	70	EAST	New Britain	72	69
NL-E	Atlanta	86	76	PCL	Colorado Springs	73	69	TEX	Springfield	71	69
AL-C	Detroit	86	77	INTL	Toledo	73	70	SOU	Tennessee	71	69
AL-W	Seattle	85	77	PCL	Salt Lake	72	71	EAST	Erie	71	70
AL-E	Tampa Bay	84	78	PCL	Iowa	72	72	TEX	San Antonio	70	70
NL-C	Chicago	83	78	INTL	Norfolk	71	71	EAST	Harrisburg	70	72
NL-C	Milwaukee	80	82	PCL	Fresno	71	73	EAST	Trenton	69	72
AL-C	Chicago	79	83	PCL	Las Vegas	71	73	EAST	Portland	67	74
NL-C	Cincinnati	78	84	INTL	Lehigh Valley	71	73	SOU	Mobile	66	74
AL-W	Oakland	75	87	INTL	Indianapolis	70	73	SOU	Mississippi	65	73
NL-W	San Diego	75	87	INTL	Rochester	70	74	SOU	Carolina	65	74
AL-E	Toronto	75	87	PCL	Oklahoma City	69	75	SOU	Chattanooga	65	74
NL-C	Houston	74	88	INTL	Charlotte	67	76	SOU	Montgomery	65	74
NL-W	Arizona	70	92	PCL	Omaha	64	80	EAST	New Hampshire	64	78
NL-E	New York	70	92	PCL	New Orleans	63	80	SOU	Huntsville	63	75
AL-C	Cleveland	65	97	PCL	Round Rock	63	81	SOU	West Tennessee	62	78
AL-C	Kansas City	65	97	INTL	Pawtucket	61	82	EAST	Altoona	62	80
AL-E	Baltimore	64	98	PCL	Portland	60	84	TEX	Arkansas	61	79
NL-C	Pittsburgh	62	99	INTL	Columbus	57	85	TEX	Corpus Christi	61	79
NL-E	Washington	59	103	INTL	Buffalo	56	87	EAST	Binghamton	54	86

*** = 2009 World Series winner
** = 2009 World Series loser
* = in 2009 MLB playoffs

The 2009 BPL first-round matchups:

- (1) New York Yankees vs (8) San Francisco Giants
- (4) Boston Red Sox vs (5) Philadelphia Phillies

- (3) Los Angeles Dodgers vs (6) Colorado Rockies
- (2) Los Angeles Angels vs (7) St. Louis Cardinals

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